From: Chief finance officer <CFO@Beago.co.bl>
To: Senior business analyst <SBA@Beago.co.bl>
Date: xx September 20X4
Subject: Disruptive technologies

The CEO has just emailed me about a conference he attended yesterday which focused on the impact of disruptive technologies on our industry. He is concerned that these disruptive technologies will have a negative impact on Beago in the coming years.

I have forwarded his comments below. I would appreciate your thoughts on this.

FORWARDED MESSAGE

Two of the disruptive technologies which I am most concerned about are:

Driverless (autonomous) vehicles

Although not used by us, some TNCs in other countries are testing autonomous vehicles in certain cities around the world. This is still some way away from being fully operational, but it is likely to be of growing interest in the coming years and will be actively adopted by some of our competitors in Bealand. My concerns are that first, autonomous vehicle technology is going to be very expensive and second, it could result in significant lawsuits if the technology goes wrong and causes accidents, as has happened in a recent test operated by an overseas TNC. Personally, I cannot see the point of eliminating human drivers from our service.

Internet of Things (IoT)

The IoT represents an expansion of the internet to include physical devices and objects which, once connected to the IoT, can generate data for users who are able to control those devices and objects through an Internet connection.

Local authorities are using sensors in traffic signals to understand traffic flow and can then remotely and instantly change traffic signals to direct and control traffic within the busiest areas. Although this helps ease traffic congestion, it could mean that our own route-planning systems, which are used to work out optimum routes for customers and drivers, could be severely disrupted by these systems. If we need to re-route journeys this would likely add additional miles and cost onto our customers and increase inconvenience.

Another example of IoT application is the introduction of cameras, which read vehicle registration numbers in designated clean air zones (CAZs). CAZs are areas in a city where measures have been introduced to improve air quality. When a vehicle drives within a CAZ, the driver is automatically charged a fee. Many cities across Bealand are proposing to implement these in the next three years. This technology will impact specifically on our drivers who may be discouraged from driving for us within city centres as they will be charged each time they enter a designated CAZ, which could be a significant number of times daily. Only drivers of electric vehicles (EVs) will be exempt from the charges.

These were just a couple of examples of the disruptive technologies already starting to impact on our business. I believe that these are quite worrying developments for our whole industry.